

Esteban Torres

ENGINEERING MANAGER / HEAD OF ENGINEERING

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Engineering leader with 15+ years in tech and 7+ years managing engineering teams at Spotify, SoundCloud, Zenjob, and Peec AI. Track record across the full leadership ladder: individual high-performing teams, multi-EM organizations (3 EMs / 30+ engineers at Zenjob Supply), and platform-wide impact (Head of Platform Engineering at Zenjob, now leading platform at Peec AI). Hands-on full-stack foundation in modern web (Node.js, React, TypeScript) and backend (Go, gRPC, NATS), with cloud-native infrastructure (Kubernetes, AWS, Terraform) and production AI experience (multi-provider LLM, embeddings, agent loops). Berlin-based.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Leadership

Engineering Management, Multi-Team & Multi-EM Organizations, Hiring & Career Development, Performance Calibration, Cross-Functional Partnership (Product, Design, Architecture), Distributed Teams Across Time Zones, Strategic Planning, Stakeholder Management

Modern Stack

Node.js, React, Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui, Go, Ruby, Swift, gRPC (with Protobuf/Buf), Pub/Sub (NATS JetStream), PostgreSQL, Microservices, Distributed Systems

Cloud & Platform

Kubernetes, AWS, Terraform, Docker, Infrastructure-as-Code, CI/CD Pipelines, Release Management, API Gateways, Observability (DataDog, Prometheus, Grafana), DORA Metrics, Incident Response & On-Call

AI-Native Development

GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Claude Code (organization-wide rollout at Zenjob across 60 engineers), Multi-Provider LLM Integration (Anthropic, OpenAI, Google Vertex AI), Embeddings & Semantic Search, Agent Loops with Tool Calling, Prompt Engineering

WORK EXPERIENCE

Peec AI -- Engineering Manager -- August 2026 to present

Leading the platform team that sets up the foundations the other engineering teams build on.

Platform work behind Peec AI's AI search analytics product, used by marketing teams.
Berlin-based, early-stage.

Zenjob -- Head of Platform Engineering -- October 2025 to August 2026

Led the Platform organization (5 direct including 1 EM, 8 indirect) supporting 60+ product engineers across the company. Owning infrastructure, observability, and developer tooling.

Treated the platform as an internal product: roadmap shaped by product-team friction, success measured in developer experience.

Standardized monitoring, alerting, and incident response across the org via Infrastructure-as-Code.

Drove company-wide rollout of AI-assisted development (Copilot, Cursor, Claude Code) across 60 engineers, including governance with Security and Legal.

Partnered with peer Heads of Engineering and the CTO on dependencies and strategy.

Zenjob -- Head of Engineering (Supply Vertical) -- January 2025 to October 2025

Led engineering for the Supply vertical (9 direct including 3 Engineering Managers, 30+ indirect), reporting directly to the CTO.

Bridged Product, Design, and cross-functional teams on a company-wide mobile platform migration (native iOS/Android to React Native) with evolving scope and tight timelines.

Hired and developed engineering leadership; conducted regular performance reviews and structured 1:1s.

Zenjob -- Engineering Manager (Platform & DevOps) -- May 2023 to January 2025

Led a team of 6 engineers building Kubernetes infrastructure, CI/CD pipelines, AWS, and platform services.

Delivered an API Gateway and APM service. Improved CI/CD pipeline stability by over 50%. Introduced DORA-aligned metrics across the organization.

Coached engineers from mid-level to senior through structured career development.

Spotify -- Engineering Manager (Remote) -- January 2022 to May 2023

Led a distributed team of 8 engineers (grew to 12, split into 2 specialized squads) across Sweden, the UK, Germany, Colorado, and New York, building Backstage, Spotify's open-source developer platform.

Post-split, managed half the team directly and 1 Engineering Manager who owned the other squad.

Defined the plugin marketplace architecture and contribution model. Shipped 3 monetized plugins, establishing a new revenue stream for Spotify.

Balanced product velocity with platform health (extensibility, contribution model, documentation).

SoundCloud -- Engineering Manager, Back-End Engineering Productivity -- October 2019 to January 2022

Led the BEEP and Core Clients teams (~8 ICs) owning JVMKit, a shared platform powering 200+ microservices serving 175M+ monthly users.

Drove reliability, performance, and extensibility for shared infrastructure used by every engineering team in the organization.

Coached engineers from mid-level to senior through structured feedback and career development.

SoundCloud -- Core Clients Engineer -- July 2017 to February 2020

Built developer tooling (Swift + Ruby) that reduced compile times by 7 minutes and integration time by 50%.

Improved playback performance by 15 seconds by extracting and refactoring Offline Sync into its own framework, increasing total listening time by 10%.

Built Prometheus-integrated observability tools for system monitoring at scale.

SoundCloud -- iOS Developer -- October 2016 to July 2017

Architected module extraction into micro features with clear API boundaries adopted across the iOS organization.

Earlier Career -- 2005 to 2016

Progressive engineering and leadership roles including Co-Founder at Craft Collective, Mobile Lead Engineer at Log(n)

(built team of 4), iOS Developer at Brewbot (connected-hardware startup), and iOS Technical Lead at Samtec (built department of 6). Over a decade of hands-on engineering across mobile, backend, and tooling.

PRODUCTION SIDE PROJECTS

Quik

Production AI agent platform built in Go with gRPC services (Protobuf, Buf), NATS JetStream for Pub/Sub messaging, multi-tier LLM inference, embeddings pipeline with semantic search, and agent loops with schema-validated tool calling. Self-hosted SaaS architecture with full audit trails.

BlueTip

Production AI writing platform built with Node.js, Next.js, React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui, and Stripe. Multi-provider LLM integration (Anthropic, OpenAI, Google Vertex AI) with streaming, guardrails, and tool-use.

OPEN SOURCE

Backstage (Spotify) -- Contributor to [Backstage](#), open-source developer platform.

OSS Community -- Active across [CocoaPods](#), [Moya](#) (Swift 2.0 migration), [ReSwift](#), [RxSwiftCommunity](#); contributions to Fastlane (sign team support), FBSnapshotTestCase (device-agnostic support).

EDUCATION

Licenciatura en Sistemas (~Licentiate Degree in Computer Science) 2003 to 2007

Universidad Latina de Costa Rica

iOS Development Bootcamp 2012

Big Nerd Ranch, Atlanta